

3. North America was the first English-speaking colony, but it developed a distinct form of English with different spellings.

4. English became the dominant language in Great Britain during the Middle Ages (5th to 15th centuries).

5. A 2010 survey found that around two-thirds of Europeans can speak some English.

6. Today, English is an international language of business, and is taught in schools in many Asian countries, including Japan and China.

7. In India and parts of Africa, English was imposed as the administrative language through centuries of colonial rule, but—in most cases—it was spoken only as a second language by the local populations.

8. The expansion of the British Empire during the 1700s in Australia and New Zealand saw European populations quickly outnumber indigenous populations, and English became the dominant language.



What's that?

English speakers around the world use different words and pronunciation, according to their background, age, and sense of identity. An accent is the way in which the words are pronounced, while a dialect refers to the use of certain vocabulary and grammatical constructions. In the UK alone, there are many distinctive dialects, such as Geordie (Newcastle), Brummie (Birmingham), and Doric (northeast Scotland). Similarly, around the world, English is spoken and written in many different ways, so that some common objects are called by different names in Britain, America, Canada, and Australia.

fizzy drink
soda pop

flip-flops
thongs

knapsack
backpack rucksack

A path at the side of the road for pedestrians is called a *pavement* in Britain, a *sidewalk* in North America, and a *footpath* in Australia.

pavement
sidewalk
footpath

jumper
sweater

The British call a knitted garment with long sleeves a *jumper*. In North America, this is called a *sweater*.

sweet pepper
bell pepper
capsicum

trousers
pants

trainers
runners sneakers